MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 6

"Collision"

Episode 2x06. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x06. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Thursday, October 20, 2005, 7:46 AM through 11:42 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 41 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x05

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Thursday, October 20, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Thursday, October 20, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Lorraine Fuller (new)	Patient: impaled, aortic injury	Jun 12, 1964	41
Dwayne Ricks (new)	Patient: impaled; Nassau County court officer	Feb 27, 1967	38
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern (on leave); triage	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery; Incident Commander	Jun 2, 1958	47
Bernadette 'Bernie' Watkins	Executive Assistant to the Chief	Jun 6, 1950	55
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant	Aug 16, 1976	29
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (24 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Tamar Wells (new)	Patient: epidural hematoma, placental abruption	Aug 18, 1974	31
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern (medicine)	Jun 11, 1978	27
Keith Brantley (new)	Lorraine's boyfriend; architect	Sep 9, 1962	43
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Franklin Bassett, Esq.	General Counsel	Oct 28, 1958	46
Monica Ricks (new)	Dwayne's wife; postal clerk	May 5, 1969	36
Mrs. Evangeline Truitt	Trustee	Dec 1, 1934	70
Rev. Isaac Ashworth	Trustee	Mar 30, 1937	68
Judge Harold Kittredge (new)	Trustee	Feb 6, 1940	65
Chairman Theodore Rawlings (new)	Chairman, Board of Trustees	Jul 1, 1938	67
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Victor Donohue	(V.O.)	May 30, 1933	72

Also appearing: FDNY firefighters and paramedics, a radiologist, an OB resident, a NICU nurse, an anesthesiologist, a scrub tech, crash victims, Baby Girl Wells (Hope), trustees Dexter Hollingsworth, Cora Edmonds, James Calloway, Dr. Augusta Freeman and Simeon Howell, and a restaurant host (V.O.).

COLD OPEN

1 INT. LIRR TRAIN - CAR 4 - MORNING
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 7:46 AM

A packed rush-hour Long Island Rail Road train from Huntington, westbound toward Penn Station on the Main Line. Commuters with coffee, newspapers, iPods. The Daily News headline in one man's hands: "SADDAM ON TRIAL." On another: "WILMA: STRONGEST ATLANTIC HURRICANE EVER."

Standing in the vestibule, holding the same vertical steel pole: LORRAINE FULLER (41), a Bloomingdale's buyer in a camel coat, with a cell phone at her ear; and DWAYNE RICKS (38), a Nassau County court officer in uniform, reading a paperback.

LORRAINE
(into the phone, laughing)
Keith. Keith. (beat) I'm not saying it on a train. (beat) Because I'm forty-one and you've had four years to say it first. (beat) Tonight. Dinner. I'll say it at dinner.

She hangs up, smiling. She catches Dwayne smiling at the paperback. He glances up.

DWAYNE
(apologetic)
Sorry. It's a small train.

LORRAINE
(laughing)
Four years. I've never said it. He's never said it. (beat) We're both too proud.

DWAYNE
(beat)
My wife and I said it on the second date. (beat) Twelve years. Three kids. (beat) Say it, lady. Life's short.

LORRAINE
(beat)
Tonight.

The train rocks through Woodside. Out the window, the Manhattan skyline appears through the October haze.

MARC (V.O.)
They say you never see the big ones coming.

A shriek of metal. Brakes. The car lurches violently. Lorraine and Dwayne slam into each other against the pole.

MARC (V.O.)
That's not true. (beat) You always see them coming. You just don't know what you're looking at.

CRASH. Darkness.

2 EXT. GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - RIVERFRONT PROMENADE - MORNING
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 7:53 AM

A clear, cool October morning, finally. Marc (26) walks along the promenade at an easy pace beside Amond (26), sixteen days post-op, in a hoodie, walking very deliberately. His ten minutes.

AMOND
This is undignified.

MARC
Your mother left a list.

AMOND
My mother leaves lists the way other people leave tips.

Both their pagers go off at once. Then Marc's phone. Then Amond's. They look at the screens.

PAGER: "*** CODE TRIAGE - EXTERNAL - MASS CASUALTY - ALL SURGICAL STAFF REPORT ***"

In the distance, across the rooftops of Queens: sirens. Many. Coming from the east.

AMOND
(staring at the pager)
Mass casualty.

MARC
(already turning)
Go home, Amond.

AMOND
(already walking toward the hospital, fast, his hand on his abdomen)
Absolutely not.

MARC (V.O.)
And by the time you do, you're already inside it.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:06 AM

Controlled chaos. Ambulances backing in, three at a time. Staff spilling out of every door. Natasha (47), in her white coat with an orange "INCIDENT COMMANDER" vest over it, stands on the loading platform with a megaphone and a clipboard. Bernie (55) beside her with a radio. Robert, Elxa, Graves, Crump, Lowery and Clayton gather below.

NATASHA
(through the megaphone)
Listen to me! An eastbound LIRR work train and a westbound Huntington commuter train collided on the Main Line just east of Woodside at seven forty-eight. (beat) OEM says three cars derailed. Early count is one hundred forty injured. (beat) We're the closest Level One. We're getting the worst of them.

A murmur. She raises a hand.

NATASHA
(crisp)
Red tags: Pit, Trauma One through Six, with Dr. Elxa Bullock and Dr. Robert Bullock. (beat) Neuro: Dr. Graves, Trauma Seven and OR Six. (beat) OB: Dr. Hartwell. Pregnant passengers to L&D. (beat) Ortho: Dr. Toussaint in the old cast room. (beat) Pediatrics: Dr. Crump. (beat) Yellow and green tags go to the ambulatory clinic with Dr. Whitlow's medicine team.

Whitlow (56), standing at the edge of the group in his three-piece suit, nods graciously, as if receiving an honor.

NATASHA
(lowering the megaphone, to Bernie)
Call every OR. Cancel the elective cases. (beat) And call the board chair. (beat) Tell him we're in a disaster.

BERNIE
(dialing)
The board still meets at five, Chief?

NATASHA
(beat)
That depends on Horace.

She looks across the bay at Whitlow. He smiles back at her.

4 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:21 AM

The doors bang open. Four paramedics and two FDNY firefighters wheel in a strange, terrible double load: two stretchers lashed side by side. Lying on them, face to face, as if embracing: Lorraine Fuller and Dwayne Ricks. A single length of steel pole, cut off with a rescue saw at both ends, runs through both of their bodies at the waist.

Everyone in the Pit stops for half a second.

TEE ROLLINS
(pushing, shouting)
Two victims, one pole! Vestibule handrail, sheared at the derailment! Through the female's left flank and out her right side, and into the male's right lower abdomen! (beat) Female's Lorraine Fuller, forty-one. Male's Dwayne Ricks, thirty-eight. (beat) Both awake. Both talking. FDNY cut the pole at the car so we could move them together.

Elxa (28), twenty-four weeks pregnant, and Robert (49) move in. Marc, just arrived, out of breath, is right behind them. Raven (25) and Harmony (26) follow.

ELXA
Nobody touches the pole. Nobody. (beat) Two of everything. Two monitors. Two lines each. Type and cross ten units each.

Lorraine, her face inches from Dwayne's, is gray and shaking but talking.

LORRAINE
(through her teeth)
We have to stop meeting like this.

DWAYNE
(gasping, almost laughing)
Lady, you said tonight.

ROBERT
(to Marc)
Dr. Bullock. Junior. You're on Mrs. Fuller. Dr. Ellison, you're on Mr. Ricks. You don't leave your patient. You don't let go of anything until I say so. (beat) CT, both of them together, in four minutes.

MARC
(moving to Lorraine's side)
Ms. Fuller. I'm Dr. Bullock. I'm staying with you.

LORRAINE
(looking up at him)
Bullock. (beat) Like the Chief? (beat) I read about her. Bloomingdale's sponsored a Donohue gala.

MARC
(steady)
Bullock's a common name, Ms. Fuller.

LORRAINE
(beat, a faint smile)
Liar.

5 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:29 AM

A third wave of ambulances. A Red Cross triage tent is half up. Amond, in a hoodie and jeans with his Queens Grace ID clipped on, walks into the middle of the bay and picks up a box of triage tags off a cart.

Robert, coming out to grab a stretcher, stops dead.

ROBERT
Dr. Baker. You're on medical leave.

AMOND
(not looking up, sorting tags)
I'm not scrubbing. I'm not lifting. I'm not touching a sterile field. (beat) I'm reading people. (beat) It's a mass casualty, sir. You need someone who reads people fast.

Natasha comes down the ramp with her megaphone. She sees Amond. She sees Robert's face.

NATASHA
(beat)
Robert. All hands. (beat) He doesn't scrub. He tags.

ROBERT
(beat)
Tasha, he had six units sixteen days ago.

NATASHA
(beat)
And today he's the best triage officer I'm going to get in the next ninety seconds. (to Amond) Dr. Baker. If you get dizzy, you sit. If you sit, I'll know.

AMOND
(already moving toward the next ambulance)
Yes, ma'am.

He reaches the first stretcher, a moaning man in a bloody suit. Amond looks at him for exactly four seconds: the color, the breathing, the eyes.

AMOND
(writing, ripping off a tag)
Yellow. Tibia. Breathing fine. Ortho. (to the next) Red. Tension physiology, no breath sounds on the left. Pit, now. (to the next) Green. Lacerations, walking, talking, angry. Clinic. (to the next, softer) Black.

He stops at that one for one second longer than the others. Then he moves on.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - TRIAGE - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:37 AM

TAMAR WELLS (31), thirty-three weeks pregnant, a teacher's aide, lies on a gurney, confused, a scalp laceration bleeding into her hair, one pupil slightly larger than the other. Clayton (34) runs an ultrasound over her belly. Graves (52) shines a light in her eyes. Esther (26) stands between them.

CLAYTON
(reading the screen)
Thirty-three weeks. Retroplacental clot. (beat) Abruption. Fetal heart rate's ninety and dropping.

GRAVES
(lowering the penlight)
And her right pupil's sluggish. Her GCS has dropped from fourteen to twelve since the bus. (beat) She has a bleed in her head.

Clayton and Graves look at each other across the gurney.

CLAYTON
(quickly)
The baby needs to come out in the next ten minutes.

GRAVES
(quickly)
Her head needs to be opened in the next twenty.

ESTHER
(beat)
Then do both. (beat) At the same time. In OR Six.

The two men look at her.

ESTHER
(steady)
Dr. Hartwell at the belly, Dr. Graves at the head. Two teams. One anesthesiologist. (beat) It's been done. I've read the case reports.

GRAVES
(beat, dry)
Dr. Smilley, Policy 4.12 says you and Dr. Hartwell may not be in the same operating room.

ESTHER
(meeting his eyes)
Policy 4.12 never met a train crash, Dr. Graves.

Clayton looks at his wife. A flicker of pride. Graves considers for one second.

GRAVES
(to the nurse)
OR Six. Both teams. Now. (to Esther) You're with me at the head. (beat) He stays at his end of the table.

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OLD CAST ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:44 AM

A dusty, rarely used plaster room converted into an ortho triage bay: six stretchers, splint rolls everywhere. Camille Toussaint (29), in a scrub cap printed with fleurs-de-lis, sets a dislocated shoulder with one ferocious pull. The patient yells. The shoulder clunks into place.

CAMILLE
(cheerfully)
There! Back where God put it! (to Harmony, who has run in with a splint kit) Choir. Thank the Lord. (beat) Bed three, open ankle. Bed five, a wrist like a dinner fork.

HARMONY
(moving to bed three)
I was in the Pit. They sent me.

CAMILLE
(moving to bed five)
I asked for you. By name. (beat) Natasha Donohue said "Choir?" I said "Divine." She said, "Ah."

Harmony looks at her across the room. Camille grins.

CAMILLE
(wrapping the wrist)
Friday was nice.

HARMONY
(beat, unable to stop smiling)
Friday was nice.

CAMILLE
You danced.

HARMONY
(beat)
You made me dance.

CAMILLE
(beat)
I asked. You said yes. (beat) That's not the same as making.

They work. A minute. Then a new stretcher rolls in: a girl of about twelve, crying, her forearm bent. Harmony goes to her immediately. Camille watches her go: the softness in the way she bends down, the voice.

CAMILLE
(to herself, quietly)
Lord, help me.

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CT SCANNER - CONTROL ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:58 AM

Through the glass: two bodies on the CT table at once, side by side, joined by the pole, sliding through the scanner's ring. In the control room: Robert, Elxa, Marc, Raven and a RADIOLOGIST at the screens.

RADIOLOGIST
(scrolling)
The male first. (beat) Pole enters right lower quadrant, through bowel, exits the right flank. Misses the iliac vessels by a couple of centimeters. (beat) He's lucky.

RAVEN
(exhaling)
He's lucky.

RADIOLOGIST
(scrolling to the other body)
The female. (beat) Pole enters the left flank, passes through the retroperitoneum... (beat) ...and through the aorta. Infrarenal. It's going in one side of the vessel and out the other.

Silence in the control room.

ELXA
(very quietly)
The pole's the only thing holding her aorta closed.

ROBERT
(staring at the screen)
It's corked. The steel is plugging both holes in the vessel wall. (beat) As long as it stays exactly where it is, she doesn't bleed.

MARC
(slowly)
And to get Mr. Ricks off the pole, we have to move it.

Robert turns from the screen and looks at his son.

ROBERT
(quietly)
When we take him off the pole, Dr. Bullock, she dies. (beat) Probably in under a minute.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 9:09 AM

Back in Trauma 1, the two stretchers still lashed together. Lorraine and Dwayne lie face to face, the pole between them. Robert stands at the foot of the double bed. Marc is at Lorraine's head, Raven at Dwayne's.

ROBERT
(quietly, to both of them)
Mrs. Fuller. Mr. Ricks. (beat) I'm going to tell you exactly what we saw, because you both deserve that.

Lorraine looks at Marc's face before Robert says another word. She reads it.

LORRAINE
(calm)
I'm the one who dies.

Dwayne makes a sound.

ROBERT
(beat)
The pole went through your aorta, Mrs. Fuller. The biggest blood vessel in your body. Right now, the pole itself is sealing the holes. (beat) When we move it to free Mr. Ricks, the holes open. (beat) We'll be ready. We'll try to clamp it. (beat) But I won't lie to you. The chances are very small.

DWAYNE
(desperately)
Then don't move it. Leave it. Take her first. Take her off first.

ROBERT
(gently)
Mr. Ricks, it doesn't matter which direction we move it. The pole has to come out of her aorta either way. (beat) If we try to take it out of her first, you both bleed.

Dwayne closes his eyes. Tears run down his face onto Lorraine's coat.

LORRAINE
(looking at him, gently)
Hey. Court officer. (beat) Look at me.

Dwayne opens his eyes. Their faces are six inches apart.

LORRAINE
(steady)
Three kids. Twelve years. You said it on the second date. (beat) You're going home.

DWAYNE
(sobbing)
Lady, I don't even know your name.

LORRAINE
(a faint smile)
Lorraine. (beat) Lorraine Fuller. Bloomingdale's, fifty-ninth and Lex, shoes and handbags. (beat) Tell your wife a stranger on the train said she's lucky.

10 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 9:24 AM

Robert has gone to set up the OR. Lorraine lies with her eyes half closed. Marc holds her hand. Raven, on the other side, quietly checks Dwayne's lines.

LORRAINE
(eyes closed)
Dr. Bullock.

MARC
I'm here.

LORRAINE
(beat)
How long?

MARC
(beat, honest)
They're preparing the operating room. About an hour. (beat) Then they'll take you both in together.

LORRAINE
(beat)
An hour. (beat) That's a long time to do nothing.

MARC
(beat)
What would you like to do with it?

She opens her eyes and looks at him. Surprised. Nobody's asked her that.

LORRAINE
(beat)
Keith. (beat) My boyfriend. Four years. (beat) I was going to tell him I love him at dinner tonight. (beat) I was so proud. I said, "You go first." For four years I made a grown man go first.

MARC
(quietly)
Where is he?

LORRAINE
His office. Fifty-third and Madison. He's an architect. (beat) He'll be in a meeting. He's always in a meeting. (beat) His number's in my phone. It's in my coat.

Marc looks at the coat, pinned between her and Dwayne, skewered by the pole.

MARC
(beat)
Then I'll find it.

He reaches carefully into the coat pocket on the side away from the pole. Dwayne, eyes closed, helps without being asked, moving his own arm an inch so Marc can get to it. Marc pulls out a Nokia, its screen cracked. He scrolls. "KEITH (DON'T BE CUTE)."

LORRAINE
(half laughing, half crying)
He put that in himself.

Marc presses CALL.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE PIT - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 9:33 AM

Natasha, in her incident commander vest, walks fast with a radio. Marc steps into her path, Lorraine's cell phone in his hand.

MARC
Chief.

NATASHA
(not stopping)
Walk with me.

MARC
(walking)
My patient's going to die in about an hour. (beat) Her boyfriend's on his way from Midtown. The trains aren't running. He's coming over the Queensboro Bridge on a bike.

NATASHA
(beat)
I'll have Big Ray meet him at the door. (beat) Marc. (beat) Walk with me one more minute.

She pulls him into an empty supply alcove. Very low, very fast.

NATASHA
The board still meets at five. Horace won't postpone. He says, quote, "The board doesn't stop for weather." (beat) He had lunch with Judge Kittredge at the Harvard Club on Monday. He'll have the yearbook.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

NATASHA
(beat)
I can sit there and let him make it look like a family scandal. (beat) Or I can stand up first, in executive session, behind closed doors, and tell eight trustees myself: my son is an intern here, here's my recusal letter, here's proof the Foundation doesn't pay his salary, here's his match. (beat) Full disclosure. Before Horace gets the chance.

A long beat. Down the hall, a man screams in the Pit.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Your grandfather says it's your decision. (beat) So does your father. (beat) So do I. (beat) Eight people. Confidential. Not the hospital. Not your roommates. Not the press. (beat) The board.

Marc looks at his mother. Then down at the cracked phone in his hand: "KEITH (DON'T BE CUTE)."

MARC
(finally)
Tell them.

NATASHA
(beat)
Marc...

MARC
(firm)
I've got a patient who waited four years to say something true. (beat) She's going to say it today because she has to. (beat) Tell them, Mama. (beat) Don't let Whitlow say it first.

Natasha looks at her son. She nods once. Then she's gone, back into the chaos with her radio.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 6 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 9:41 AM

The most crowded OR in the building. Tamar Wells under general anesthesia. At the head, her skull shaved and draped: Graves and Esther, a drill in Graves's hand. At her belly, a second sterile field: Clayton, an assisting OB RESIDENT and a NICU team standing by with a warmer. One anesthesiologist between them, managing both.

CLAYTON
(at the belly)
Skin. (beat) Fascia. (beat)
Uterus. (beat) Baby's out.

A tiny, limp girl comes out in Clayton's hands. He passes her to the NICU team. A long, terrible silence. Then a weak, angry cry.

NICU NURSE
(calling)
She's crying! Apgars six!

At the head of the table, Esther doesn't look up. But her hands, holding the retractor, relax by a millimeter.

GRAVES
(drilling)
Burr hole. (beat) Craniotomy.
(beat) Dr. Smilley, there it is.
Acute epidural, temporal. (beat)
Suction.

Esther suctions the dark clot. Graves coagulates the bleeding artery.

CLAYTON
(from the belly,
without looking up)
Placenta's out. Uterus is
firming. Bleeding's controlled.

GRAVES
(without looking
up)
Epidural's evacuated. Brain's
re-expanding.

A rare beat of quiet in the room.

Esther glances across the patient, past the drapes, at her husband. He's looking at her too, over his mask. A long, quiet look. Nobody in the room says anything. Graves notices. Graves notices everything.

GRAVES
(dry, not looking up)
Irrigate, Dr. Smilley. (beat) You can look at your husband after the dura's closed.

13 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:02 AM

The bay, slightly calmer now. Amond still stands at the center of it, a stack of tags in his hand. He's pale. Sweat on his upper lip. He's been on his feet for ninety minutes. Arianna (25), running past with a gurney, stops.

ARIANNA
Baker. Sit down.

AMOND
(tagging a man with a head laceration, green)
I'm fine.

ARIANNA
(beat)
You said that on October third.

Amond stops. He looks at her. Then at the low concrete wall beside the bay.

He sits down on it. Slowly. One hand on his abdomen.

AMOND
(beat)
Ninety-one patients. (beat) I've tagged ninety-one patients.

ARIANNA
(sitting beside him, taking the tags out of his hand)
I know. (beat) Gloria's been counting. She says you haven't been wrong once.

AMOND
(beat)
I was wrong once. (beat) The black tag. Car three. (beat) I gave him four seconds. (beat) He might have had a pulse.

ARIANNA
(quietly)
He didn't. (beat) I checked him again for you at nine-fifteen. No pulse, no breathing, fixed pupils. (beat) You weren't wrong, Baker.

Amond looks at her. He closes his eyes.

AMOND
(barely)
Thank you.

ARIANNA
(beat, handing him a bottle of water)
Drink. (beat) And then tag. Sitting down.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULATORY CLINIC - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:14 AM

The clinic, converted into a sea of green-tagged walking wounded. Whitlow moves among them with genuine competence: an excellent internist, calm and kind with patients. Kennerly follows him with a clipboard.

WHITLOW
(to a shaken commuter, gently)
Your heart is fine, sir. You're having a panic attack. That's an entirely reasonable response to a train crash. (beat) Sit. Breathe. A nurse will bring you tea.

He moves on. Kennerly falls into step.

KENNERLY
(low)
The Chief's son is on the pole case. In the Pit. (beat) The double impalement. He's been with the woman since eight-twenty.

WHITLOW
(not looking at him, examining a cut)
The Chief's son, Dr. Kennerly?

KENNERLY
(beat)
Bullock.

WHITLOW
(beat, mildly)
We don't know that yet. (beat) We'll know at five. (beat) Steri-strips, please.

WHITLOW
(to the girl, warmly)
There. You're very brave. (beat) Braver than most grown-ups I know.

15 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE ENTRANCE - DAY

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:23 AM

A man in a rumpled suit and a bicycle helmet skids to a stop at the curb on a battered road bike, soaked in sweat, gasping: KEITH BRANTLEY (43), architect. He drops the bike on the sidewalk. Big Ray (45) is waiting at the door.

KEITH
(gasping)
Lorraine. Lorraine Fuller. (beat) A doctor called me. A Dr. Bullock.

BIG RAY
(picking up the bike, gently)
I know, sir. I've got your bike. (beat) Follow me. Fast.

KEITH
(running)
Is she...?

BIG RAY
(beat, running beside him)
She's waiting for you.

16 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:26 AM

Keith comes through the curtain and stops at the sight of them: the two stretchers, the pole, the woman he loves lying with a steel rod through her body six inches from a stranger. Marc, at Lorraine's head, steps back to make room.

KEITH
(barely)
Rainy.

LORRAINE
(smiling, so tired)
You rode a bike. (beat) You hate bikes.

KEITH
(dropping to his knees by her head, taking her face)
The trains weren't running.

LORRAINE
(beat)
Keith. (beat) Listen. (beat) We don't have long. And there's a court officer here who's very invested in this, so I'm going to say it in front of him.

Dwayne, eyes closed, squeezes Raven's hand very hard.

LORRAINE
(looking into Keith's eyes)
I love you. (beat) I've loved you since the second date, at that terrible Ethiopian place on Ninth Avenue, when you spilled the honey wine on my good shoes and offered to buy me new ones and I said "I'm a shoe buyer, I don't pay retail." (beat) Four years. I was too proud to go first. (beat) I'm going first. (beat) I love you.

KEITH
(sobbing)
I love you. (beat) I love you. I love you. I was going to say it tonight. I made a reservation. (beat) I made a reservation, Rainy.

LORRAINE
(laughing through tears)
I know. (beat) I know you did.

Marc stands at the wall. Raven, across the stretchers, is crying silently. Marc isn't. He's very, very still.

Robert appears at the curtain in a surgical cap.

ROBERT
(gently)
It's time.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:51 AM

Two operating tables pushed together. Lorraine and Dwayne, under general anesthesia, still joined by the pole. Two surgical teams: Elxa and Lowery (58) at Dwayne's abdomen; Robert and Marc at Lorraine's, her abdomen open, the aorta exposed and the pole visible running straight through it. Vascular clamps laid out, ready. Six units of blood hanging for her, warmed. A rapid infuser.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Proximal control. Clamp on the aorta above the pole, just below the renals. (beat) Dr. Bullock. Hand.

Marc hands him the clamp. Robert places it on the aorta above the pole.

ROBERT
Clamped. (beat) Distal control. Below the pole. Both iliacs.

Marc helps place two more clamps below.

ROBERT
(beat)
Every vessel feeding that segment is controlled. (beat) In theory, when the pole comes out, the hole is isolated between my clamps.

MARC
(quietly)
In theory.

ROBERT
(beat)
In theory. (beat) Her aortic wall is calcified. Forty-one, and she's a smoker. (beat) The clamps may not hold. (beat, to the other team) Dr. Bullock. Dr. Lowery. On my count, pull Mr. Ricks off the pole, toward you, one smooth motion. (beat) Three. Two. One.

On the other side of the table, Elxa and Lowery slide Dwayne's body off the pole: one smooth, terrible motion. The pole stays in Lorraine. Elxa and Lowery immediately pack Dwayne's wounds. He's free.

ROBERT
(to the scrub tech)
Now pull the pole. From her right side. Slowly.

The tech draws the pole out of Lorraine's body, inch by inch. Marc watches the aorta. The pole slides free of the vessel wall. Two holes in the aorta. For one second they stay dry, contained between the clamps.

Then the calcified wall cracks just below the upper clamp. Blood sprays up out of the field like a hose.

ROBERT
(instantly)
The wall's split above the clamp. (beat) Suction. Suction. Dr. Bullock, finger on it, there.

Marc presses his fingers into the gushing, cracked aortic wall. Blood wells around them.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
Pressure fifty. Forty. (beat) Thirty.

ROBERT
Supraceliac clamp. Above everything. (beat) Now.

Robert reaches up under the diaphragm and places a clamp on the aorta higher up. The spraying slows. Too late. The suction canister is full. The anesthesiologist pushes blood as fast as the machine allows.

ANESTHESIOLOGIST
(flat)
Pressure twenty. (beat) She's in PEA.

Marc keeps his fingers on the vessel. He doesn't move.

ROBERT
(very quietly)
Dr. Bullock.

MARC
(staring at his hands in her body)
I've got it. I've got it, Dad, it's...

The word just falls out. Lowery's head comes up. Elxa closes her eyes behind her mask. Robert says nothing for one beat.

ROBERT
(gently)
Marc. (beat) She's gone.

The monitor: a flat line. Marc keeps his fingers where they are for three more seconds. Then he lifts them. The blood doesn't spurt anymore. There's no pressure behind it.

ROBERT
(beat, to the room, quietly)
Time of death?

Marc looks up at the clock. His voice is perfectly steady.

MARC
Eleven-oh-four a.m.

On the other side of the table, Elxa and Lowery are closing Dwayne. His heart beats steadily on the monitor.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - SCRUB ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 11:21 AM

Marc at the sink, scrubbing Lorraine's blood off his forearms, long past clean. Lowery comes in, pulls down his mask and stands at the next sink.

LOWERY
(scrubbing)
You called him "Dad."

Marc's hands stop under the water.

LOWERY
(not looking at him)
On the table. (beat) "I've got it, Dad."

MARC
(beat, very quietly)
Dr. Lowery...

LOWERY
(turning off his tap, drying his hands)
I've been operating in this hospital since 1979, son. (beat) I've known your father since he came here in 1993. I've known your mother since the day she walked in as Chief of OB. (beat) And I've had a pretty good idea since about August third. You stand like him. You hold a needle driver like him. (beat) Bullock's a common name. Not that common.

He tosses the towel in the bin.

LOWERY
(at the door)
It doesn't leave this room. (beat) And for what it's worth, you held that aorta like a man twice your age. (beat) She'd have died on any table in New York today. (beat) She just happened to die on the best one.

He goes. Marc stands at the sink with the water running.

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FAMILY LOUNGE - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 11:36 AM

Keith Brantley sits alone in the family lounge, still in his bicycle helmet, which he's forgotten he's wearing. Marc comes in, in clean scrubs. Keith stands. He sees Marc's face. He sits back down.

MARC
(quietly, sitting across from him)
Mr. Brantley. (beat) Lorraine died at eleven-oh-four. (beat) The pole had split her aorta. When it came out, the vessel wall broke. We clamped above it, and then higher. (beat) She didn't wake up. She didn't feel anything.

Keith nods. He keeps nodding.

KEITH
(barely)
And the court officer?

MARC
(beat)
He's alive. He's in recovery. (beat) He's going home to his wife and three kids.

A long silence. Keith takes off the helmet and looks at it in his hands, confused, as if he doesn't remember putting it on.

KEITH
(quietly)
She said it first. (beat) Four years. (beat) She went first. (beat) She was so proud of being proud.

MARC
(beat)
She told me she made you go first for four years. (beat) Today she wanted to.

KEITH
(looking up at him, sobbing now)
Why does it take a train?

Marc doesn't have an answer. He sits with him.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 12:14 PM

A tiny girl, thirty-three weeks, four pounds even, in an isolette on CPAP, a pink knit cap on her head. A card: "BABY GIRL WELLS." Esther stands at the window looking in, still in scrub cap, her mask around her neck. Clayton comes up beside her.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Her mother's extubated. Graves says she'll have a full recovery. (beat) She asked for her daughter by name.

ESTHER
(beat)
What's her name?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Hope. (beat) Tamar said she picked it in July and thought it was too corny. (beat) She's keeping it.

They look at the baby together.

CLAYTON
(beat)
We were good today, Es. (beat) At that table.

ESTHER
(beat)
We were.

CLAYTON
(beat, carefully)
Graves said you could look at me after the dura was closed. (beat) You looked at me before.

Esther doesn't answer. Clayton doesn't push.

ESTHER
(finally, quietly)
Marc's patient died. The woman on the pole. (beat) Gloria told me in the hall.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I heard.

ESTHER
(beat)
I wanted to go find him. (beat) I didn't.

CLAYTON
(beat, gently)
You can, Es. (beat) That's allowed.

ESTHER
(shaking her head)
He said "enough." (beat) And I chose. (beat) That's also allowed.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 1:30 PM

Natasha at her desk, still in the orange vest, a sandwich untouched. Bernie hands her a thin folder. Franklin Bassett stands by the window.

BERNIE
Everything you asked for. (beat) Your recusal letter from the 2005 match, dated January ninth, countersigned by Dr. Graves as acting program director. The NRMP match list. His rank list. (beat) And a letter from the Foundation's comptroller certifying that no Foundation funds have been paid toward any resident salary at Queens Grace since 1978.

BASSETT
(quietly)
Executive session. Confidential. Minutes sealed. Each trustee signs a nondisclosure. (beat) If any of them leaks it, they're off the board and in my office.

NATASHA
(beat)
And Horace?

BASSETT
(beat)
Horace is a department chief, not a trustee. He presents his motion and leaves the room before the vote. (beat) He'll hear the disclosure, Tasha. He'll be in the room.

NATASHA
(closing the folder)
Good. (beat) I'd like him to.

The radio on her desk crackles: "Chief, we've got a pediatric red from car three." She stands, the folder under her arm.

NATASHA
(to Bernie)
The board meets at five. (beat) Until then, I'm a surgeon.

22 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL RECOVERY - BAY 4 - DAY

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 2:05 PM

Dwayne Ricks, waking up, groggy, an NG tube in, his abdomen bandaged. His wife, MONICA RICKS (36), a postal clerk, holds his hand, sobbing with relief. Raven checks his drains.

DWAYNE
(hoarse, the first thing he says)
Lorraine.

Raven looks at Monica, then at him.

RAVEN
(gently)
Mr. Ricks. (beat) She died. At eleven-oh-four. (beat) When the pole came out, her aorta tore. They tried. They clamped it twice.

Dwayne closes his eyes. Tears leak out from under the lids.

MONICA
(confused, to Raven)
Who's Lorraine?

DWAYNE
(eyes still closed)
The lady on the other side of the pole. (beat) Monica. She said to tell you... (his voice breaks) She said to tell you you're lucky.

Monica looks at her husband. Then she puts her face down on his hand and sobs.

DWAYNE
(barely)
Twelve years. We said it on the second date. (beat) She'd been waiting four years to say it. (beat) She said it today. With a pole through her. (beat) For me to hear.

23 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 2:21 PM

The bay is quiet now: the last ambulances gone, the Red Cross tent coming down. Amond sits on the low concrete wall where Arianna put him, a final stack of tags in his lap. Robert, in OR scrubs spotted with Lorraine's blood, comes out and stops in front of him.

ROBERT
(quietly)
How many?

AMOND
(beat)
One hundred and four. (beat) Ninety-nine sent to the right place the first time. Five re-triaged up. (beat) None down.

Robert looks at him for a long moment.

ROBERT
(beat)
Dr. Baker. (beat) Go home. (beat) That's an order. (beat) And a compliment.

Amond looks up at him. He opens his mouth to argue. He closes it.

AMOND
(standing slowly)
Yes, sir.

ROBERT
(beat, surprised)
"Yes, sir"?

AMOND
(beat)
I pressed the button, sir. (beat) Today. I sat down when Cummings told me to. (beat) I'm trying.

Robert puts a hand on his shoulder, briefly.

ROBERT
(quietly)
I know you are, son.

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OLD CAST ROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 2:43 PM

The makeshift ortho bay, emptied out at last. Plaster dust on everything. Camille sits on an empty stretcher eating a vending machine Snickers, her fleur-de-lis cap pushed back. Harmony comes in, exhausted, and sits beside her.

CAMILLE
(beat)
The woman on the pole. Your roommate's patient. (beat) I heard.

HARMONY
(beat)
She told her boyfriend she loved him. With a pole through her. (beat) Four years she waited. (beat) Marc said she was too proud to go first.

A long beat. Harmony looks down at her hands. Then at Camille.

HARMONY
(quietly, terrified, very brave)
Camille. (beat) Saturday. (beat) Do you want to... (beat) I want to take you somewhere. (beat) Me. I'm asking.

Camille stops chewing. She looks at Harmony for a long moment, her whole loud face suddenly very quiet.

CAMILLE
(softly)
Choir. (beat) Are you asking me out?

HARMONY
(beat)
I'm asking. (beat) I'm going first.

CAMILLE
(beat, a slow, enormous smile)
Then yes. (beat) Lord, yes.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL RECOVERY - BAY 4 - DAY

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 3:12 PM

Dwayne, propped up. Monica beside him. The curtain moves. Keith Brantley stands there, still in his rumpled suit, helmet in his hand. Raven, behind him, brought him.

KEITH
(awkward, devastated)
I'm sorry. I don't... (beat) I'm Lorraine's... (he stops) I'm Keith.

Dwayne looks at him. Then he holds out his good hand. Keith takes it.

DWAYNE
(hoarse)
She said it. (beat) To you. (beat) I heard her. I was six inches away.

KEITH
(barely)
I know.

DWAYNE
(beat)
She told me to say it. On the train. Before. (beat) She said, "Four years, he hasn't said it, I haven't said it, we're both too proud." (beat) I said, "Say it, lady. Life's short."

Keith's face crumples.

DWAYNE
(gripping his hand)
She was going to say it at dinner. (beat) She wasn't scared, man. (beat) She was excited.

Monica reaches out and puts her other hand on top of theirs. The three of them stay like that.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SUPPLY ROOM - PELL PAVILION - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 3:34 PM

A cramped supply room, shelves of IV bags and gauze. Raven comes in to restock a cart and finds Arianna sitting on the step stool in the corner, her head against the shelves, eyes closed.

RAVEN
(softly)
Hey.

ARIANNA
(eyes still closed)
Hey.

RAVEN
(closing the door behind her)
You okay?

ARIANNA
(beat)
I re-checked a black tag for Baker at nine-fifteen. (beat) Car three. Nineteen years old. A Hofstra sweatshirt. (beat) Baker was right. He was gone. (beat) I just keep seeing the sweatshirt.

Raven crouches down in front of her. She takes Arianna's hands.

RAVEN
(quietly)
Look at me.

Arianna opens her eyes.

RAVEN
(beat)
A woman told the man she loves that she loves him today, with a steel pole through her. (beat) Because she waited too long. (beat) I'm not waiting.

She leans in and kisses Arianna. Softly. Arianna goes perfectly still. Then she kisses her back.

They break apart. Foreheads touching. Arianna laughs, shaky.

ARIANNA
(whispering)
In a supply room, Ellison.

RAVEN
(whispering)
I didn't see it raining.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU CORRIDOR - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 3:52 PM

Marc walks down the corridor, in clean scrubs, a coffee in his hand, on his way back to the Pit. He passes the NICU window and slows.

Esther stands at the glass looking in at Baby Girl Wells: Hope. She senses him and turns. They look at each other through six feet of corridor.

Neither of them says anything. She knows about Lorraine; he can see it in her face. He knows she knows.

Esther nods once, very slightly: I'm sorry.

Marc nods back: I know.

He keeps walking. She turns back to the window. Her hand, with the ring on it, is pressed flat against the glass.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 4:06 PM

Elxa lies on the bottom bunk, her feet on pillows. Marc comes in, closes the door and sits on the floor against the bunk. Neither speaks for a long moment.

ELXA
(quietly)
You said "Dad." In OR One.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

ELXA
Lowery heard.

MARC
(beat)
Lowery's known since August. (beat) He told me in the scrub room. (beat) "Bullock's a common name. Not that common."

ELXA
(beat, a tired laugh)
That's Abraham Lowery. (beat) Twenty-six years in this hospital, and he's never said a word about anybody that wasn't true.

A beat. Elxa reaches down and takes his hand. She puts it on her belly.

ELXA
(softly)
Twenty-four weeks today. (beat) Viability. (beat) If this baby came today, he'd have a chance.

A kick. Strong. Right against Marc's palm.

And something in Marc, held perfectly steady all day, through the pole and the aorta and "I've got it, Dad" and eleven-oh-four and Keith's helmet and the NICU window, finally gives way. He puts his forehead down on the edge

of the bunk and cries.

Elxa doesn't say anything. She keeps his hand on her belly with one hand and puts the other on the back of his head. The baby keeps kicking.

ELXA
(barely)
I know. (beat) I know, baby brother.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - TWELFTH FLOOR - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE BOARDROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 4:52 PM

The executive floor. Polished wood, framed portraits of former Chiefs. Trustees arrive in ones and twos: MRS. EVANGELINE TRUITT (70), in lavender; REV. ISAAC ASHWORTH (68); JUDGE HAROLD KITTREDGE (65), white-bearded, with a cane; and others. Natasha, out of her orange vest now, in a dark suit, stands by the door with Bernie and Bassett. She holds the thin folder.

Whitlow (56) comes down the hall with a leather portfolio under his arm. He stops in front of her.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
Natasha. (beat) What a day. One hundred and forty patients. Remarkable work. (beat) The whole city's talking about Queens Grace.

NATASHA
(evenly)
Horace, there are eleven people dead on the Main Line, and one of them died in my OR at eleven-oh-four. (beat) Postpone this.

WHITLOW
(beat, almost gently)
The board doesn't stop for weather, Natasha. (beat) Or for train crashes. (beat) That's what makes it a board.

He goes into the boardroom. Natasha watches the door close behind him.

BASSETT
(quietly)
Last chance to change your mind.

NATASHA
(tucking the folder under her arm)
My son already made up his mind, Franklin. (beat) He said, "Don't let Whitlow say it first."

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - BOARDROOM - EXECUTIVE SESSION - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 5:04 PM

A long mahogany table under a crystal chandelier. Eight trustees, the chairman at the head: CHAIRMAN THEODORE RAWLINGS (67), a retired Con Edison executive. Mrs. Truitt, Rev. Ashworth, Judge Kittredge, MR. DEXTER HOLLINGSWORTH (60), MRS. CORA EDMONDS (58), MR. JAMES CALLOWAY (44, the new man from the bank), DR. AUGUSTA FREEMAN (71, retired pediatrician) and MR. SIMEON HOWELL (63). Bassett sits beside the chairman as counsel. Bernie takes the sealed minutes. Natasha at one end. Whitlow stands at the other, presenting.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
(gravely)
Before we begin. On behalf of this board, our thanks to every member of this staff for today. (beat) A moment of silence for the dead on the Main Line.

A moment. Then:

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
Dr. Whitlow. Your motion.

WHITLOW
(rising, gracious)
Thank you, Mr. Chairman. I'll be brief, out of respect for the day. (beat) I move that this board authorize a full review of all gifts, visits and relationships between the Victor Donohue Foundation and the medical staff of Queens Grace Hospital. (beat) Three reasons.

He opens the portfolio.

WHITLOW
(laying out documents)
First: a billion-dollar fund, and its first hospital pharmacy in New York, placed here in under twenty-four hours. (beat) Second: on August ninth, at four forty-eight in the morning, an unnamed visitor entered this hospital through the loading dock, escorted by the Chief of Security, and went to pediatric oncology. The camera, conveniently, was broken. (beat) Third...

He lays the Collegiate yearbook on the table, open to the senior page.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
...this young man. "Marc-Anthony Bullock." Collegiate School, 1997. Basketball captain. (beat) He's a first-year surgical intern in this hospital. On the Chief of Surgery's service. (beat) He tells colleagues his grandfather drove a bus in Washington. (beat) Dr. Robert Bullock's father drove a bus in Washington. (beat) The Chief of Surgery is Dr. Robert Bullock's wife. (beat) And her father is Victor Donohue.

A murmur around the table. Judge Kittredge leans forward on his cane and studies the photograph. Rev. Ashworth doesn't look at it. He looks at Natasha.

WHITLOW
(beat)
I make no accusation. (beat) I simply ask: is the Chief of Surgery supervising her own son, in secret, while her father's foundation pours money into the hospital where he trains? (beat) And if so, what else don't we know?

He sits. A heavy silence.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
(beat)
Dr. Donohue?

31 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 4 - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 5:17 PM

Twelve floors below. A late arrival from the crash site: a transit worker who was crushed digging out a car. Marc, alone with Gloria, places a chest tube. Calm, fast, perfect.

MARC
(sliding the tube in)
Tube's in. (beat) Eight hundred out. Pressure?

GLORIA
(watching the monitor)
One-oh-four over sixty. Better.

Marc secures the tube. He glances up at the clock: 5:17.

GLORIA
(quietly, not looking at him)
It's going on upstairs right now, isn't it?

MARC
(beat)
Yes.

GLORIA
(beat)
Whatever happens up there, baby, you just put a chest tube in a man at the end of a hundred-and-forty-patient day without a tremor. (beat) That's who you are. (beat) No board can vote on that.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - BOARDROOM - EXECUTIVE SESSION - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 5:24 PM

Natasha stands at her end of the table. She opens the thin folder. Her hands are perfectly steady.

NATASHA
(calm)
Mr. Chairman. Members of the board. (beat) Dr. Whitlow is correct about one thing. (beat) Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock is my son.

A ripple around the table. Hollingsworth sits back. Mrs. Edmonds raises her eyebrows. Mrs. Truitt doesn't move at all.

NATASHA
(steady)
He is the son of Dr. Robert Bullock and me, and the grandson of Dr. Victor Donohue. (beat) He applied to this residency through the National Resident Matching Program, like every other applicant. (beat) On January ninth of this year, I recused myself from his application in writing. Dr. Leland Graves, acting as program director, ranked the class. I never saw his file. (beat) Here is the letter.

She slides it to Bassett, who passes it to the chairman.

NATASHA
(beat)
Here is the match list. (beat) Here is a certified letter from the Foundation's comptroller: no Foundation money has paid any resident's salary at this hospital since 1978. (beat) My son is paid by the same Medicare graduate medical education dollars as every other intern. About forty-eight thousand dollars a year.

JUDGE KITTREDGE
(sharp)
Then why the secrecy, Dr. Donohue? (beat) Why "Bullock is a common name"? Why a bus driver? Why the loading dock?

Natasha looks at the Judge for a long moment.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Because he asked me to, Judge. (beat) When he was twenty-one, my son told me that he wanted to be the first person in his family who was judged on his own hands. Not on his grandfather's name. Not on mine. (beat) He spent four years of college in his grandmother's rowhouse in Shaw, the widow of a bus driver. He played four years of basketball at Howard for nothing but the joy of it. He rides the 7 train to this hospital every morning, and he shares his house with roommates who still don't know who he is. (beat) The loading dock on August ninth was my father, visiting a ten-year-old with neuroblastoma who wanted to talk to an astronaut. The boy died ninety minutes after Discovery landed. My son was holding his hand. (beat) None of that is a scandal. (beat) It's a young man who wanted to earn it.

Silence around the table. Judge Kittredge looks down at the yearbook photo.

NATASHA
(beat)
And today, he held a woman's split aorta closed with his fingers for ninety seconds while she died, and then he went downstairs and put a chest tube in a transit worker. (beat) He's doing that right now, twelve floors below us, while we discuss his last name.

Rev. Ashworth closes his eyes.

NATASHA
(closing the folder)
I'm telling you this myself, in a sealed session, before anyone could tell you for me. (beat) Full disclosure. (beat) Dr. Whitlow's word. Not mine.

She sits. Whitlow's face is a perfectly pleasant mask.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
(beat, clearing his throat)
Thank you, Dr. Donohue. (beat) Dr. Whitlow, Dr. Donohue, you'll both excuse us for the vote.

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - TWELFTH FLOOR - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE BOARDROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 5:49 PM

Natasha and Whitlow stand on opposite sides of the corridor, waiting, like two boxers between rounds. Bassett went back in. Bernie stands by the door. Down the hall, Kennerly lurks by the elevator.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly, without looking at her)
That was well done, Natasha.

NATASHA
(without looking at him)
It was true, Horace. That's all it was.

NATASHA
(turning to look at him at last)
My mother interviewed you in the library at Brookline in 1974. (beat) She told my father you spent the whole interview looking at the paintings. (beat) She said you wanted the house, not the work.

For the first time, Whitlow's mask slips. Just for a second.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Thirty-one years, Horace. (beat) My son has wanted the work every single day since July first.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - BOARDROOM - EXECUTIVE SESSION - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 6:02 PM

The eight trustees. Hands raised.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
On Dr. Whitlow's motion. (beat) In favor.

Hollingsworth. Edmonds. Calloway. And, after a long beat, slowly, Judge Kittredge.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
Four. (beat) Opposed.

Mrs. Truitt, instantly. Dr. Freeman. Mr. Howell. Three.

Everyone looks at Rev. Ashworth. He sits with his hands folded, looking at the yearbook photo for a long moment.

REV. ASHWORTH
(quietly)
Mr. Chairman. Before I vote, a word.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
Reverend.

REV. ASHWORTH
(beat)
Nine days ago, in that pharmacy downstairs, an eight-year-old boy from Gentilly asked me to thank God for his dog. (beat) I did. That night. (beat) And today a mother stood in this room, in front of eight people who could end her career by Monday, and told the truth before anyone could make her. (beat) I've been a pastor for forty-four years. I have heard a great many confessions. (beat) That wasn't one. That was a testimony. (beat) Opposed.

He raises his hand.

CHAIRMAN RAWLINGS
(beat)
Four to four. (beat) The motion fails for want of a majority. (beat) Mr. Bassett, seal the minutes.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - TWELFTH FLOOR - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE THE BOARDROOM - DAY
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 6:08 PM

The boardroom door opens. Bassett comes out. He looks at Natasha. A tiny nod. Then at Whitlow. Nothing.

BASSETT
(quietly)
Four to four. It fails.

Natasha exhales for what seems like the first time since 4:52. Whitlow buttons his jacket.

WHITLOW
(pleasantly)
Congratulations, Natasha. (beat)
This isn't over, of course.

NATASHA
(beat)
It is today, Horace.

WHITLOW
(beat, walking
toward the
elevator, over his
shoulder)
Eight people in that room know
now. (beat) Eight people,
Natasha. And a judge who doesn't
like your father. (beat) Secrets
are like aortas. (beat) Once you
open them, they don't close the
way they used to.

He passes Kennerly at the elevator without a word. Kennerly follows him in. The doors close.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 6:21 PM

Natasha sits in her desk chair with her shoes off and her eyes closed. Robert comes in, still in scrubs, and closes the door.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Bernie told me. (beat) Four to four. (beat) Ashworth.

NATASHA
(eyes still closed)
Ashworth.

ROBERT
(beat)
You told them.

NATASHA
(opening her eyes)
He told me to, Robert. (beat) In a supply alcove. With a dying woman's cell phone in his hand. (beat) He said, "Don't let Whitlow say it first."

Robert sits on the edge of her desk. He takes her hand.

NATASHA
(beat, very quietly)
How was he? At eleven-oh-four?

ROBERT
(beat)
Steady. (beat) Steadier than me. (beat) He called the time of death in a voice like a man of fifty. (beat) And then Elxa says he cried in the on-call room for twenty minutes with his hand on her stomach.

Natasha closes her eyes again. A tear runs down her cheek. She lets it.

37 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ROOFTOP - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 6:44 PM

The first clear night in two weeks. Manhattan glitters across the river. Marc stands at the railing. Natasha comes out of the roof door in her suit, her shoes in her hand. She stands beside him.

NATASHA
(quietly)
Four to four. The motion failed.

MARC
(beat, not turning)
Ashworth?

NATASHA
Ashworth. (beat) Because of a little boy and a dog. (beat) And because I said it before Horace could.

Marc lets out a long breath.

NATASHA
(beat)
Eight trustees know now, Marc. Under seal. (beat) And Horace. And Kennerly, probably, by tonight. (beat) It isn't the hospital. It isn't your roommates. (beat) But it isn't nobody anymore.

MARC
(beat)
I know.

NATASHA
(beat)
Are you all right with that?

Marc looks out at the city for a long moment.

MARC
(finally)
A woman waited four years to say "I love you" because she was too proud to go first. (beat) She said it today with a pole through her body. (beat) I don't want to wait till something goes through me, Mama.

Natasha looks at her son.

MARC
(beat)
I'll tell Raven and Harmony. (beat) Myself. Soon. (beat) Not because Whitlow's coming. Because they deserve to hear it from me first.

NATASHA
(beat, softly)
When?

MARC
(beat)
Soon. (beat) Not "not yet." (beat) Soon.

38 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 8:32 PM

The kitchen, warm and crowded. Raven made gumbo, because somebody died. Amond sits at the island, on his feet too long today and pretending he isn't. Harmony ladles rice. Arianna leans against the counter beside Raven, closer than she used to. Marc comes in, exhausted, and stops in the doorway.

RAVEN
(softly)
Sit down, Marc.

He sits. Harmony puts a bowl in front of him. Nobody says anything for a moment.

AMOND
(finally)
One hundred and four. (beat) I tagged one hundred and four people today.

ARIANNA
(deadpan)
He's going to tell us that every day for a year.

A small laugh around the table. Marc eats a spoonful. Then puts the spoon down.

MARC
(quietly)
Her name was Lorraine Fuller. (beat) She bought shoes for Bloomingdale's. (beat) She told her boyfriend she loved him for the first time, at ten twenty-six this morning. With a steel pole through her aorta. (beat) She died at eleven-oh-four.

Silence. Raven glances at Arianna. Arianna takes Raven's hand under the counter, where she thinks nobody can see. Harmony sees. Harmony smiles a little.

HARMONY
(gently)
You were with her. The whole time.

MARC
(beat)
The whole time.

Raven looks at Marc for a long beat. Something unasked hangs in the air between them: the Mercedes, the old man in the rain, "my brother."

MARC
(meeting Raven's eyes)
Rave. (beat) Double-O. (beat) There's something I need to tell you both. (beat) Not tonight. (beat) But soon. I promise. Soon.

Raven and Harmony exchange a look.

RAVEN
(beat, quietly)
Okay, Marc. (beat) Soon.

39 INT. CLAYTON'S SUBLET - BROOKLYN HEIGHTS - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 9:47 PM

Clayton cooks pasta. Esther sits at the counter with a glass of wine, still in her hospital fleece. The ring on her hand catches the light.

ESTHER
(quietly)
Full disclosure.

CLAYTON
(turning from the stove)
Okay.

ESTHER
(beat)
Today, in the NICU corridor, I wanted to go find Marc. (beat) After his patient died. (beat) I wanted to put my arms around him. (beat) I didn't. (beat) But I wanted to. (beat) You said no secrets. That's one.

Clayton sets down the spoon. He looks at her for a long moment.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Thank you. (beat) For telling me.

ESTHER
(beat)
You're not angry?

CLAYTON
(beat)
I'm jealous. (beat) Of a man who, as far as I can tell, has done absolutely nothing wrong. (beat) That's my problem, Es. Not yours.

He comes around the counter and sits beside her.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
We were good today. At that table. (beat) You and me and Graves and a baby named Hope.

ESTHER
(beat)
We were.

Esther looks at him. She takes his hand.

40 INT. LORRAINE FULLER'S APARTMENT - MURRAY HILL - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 10:31 PM

A small, beautiful one-bedroom on East 36th Street. Shoeboxes stacked to the ceiling in the closet, every one labeled. Keith Brantley sits on her couch, still in his suit, the bike helmet on the coffee table. He holds her landline phone.

KEITH
(into the phone, steady)
Yes. Hi. (beat) I have a reservation for tonight. Nine o'clock. (beat) Brantley. Party of two. (beat) I need to... (beat) I need to cancel it.

HOST (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Of course, Mr. Brantley. (beat) Would you like to reschedule?

Keith looks around the apartment. Her reading glasses on the side table. Her coat isn't there. Her coat is in an evidence bag at the 108th.

KEITH
(barely)
No. (beat) No, thank you.

He hangs up. He sits in the dark for a long moment. Then, very quietly, to the empty room:

KEITH
(whispering)
I love you, Rainy. (beat) I went first. (beat) I'm going first.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

41 EXT. WOODSIDE LIRR STATION - PLATFORM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2005 - 11:42 PM

The elevated platform at Woodside, above Roosevelt Avenue. The 7 train rumbles past on the tracks above. To the east, down the Main Line, floodlights blaze over the crash site: three derailed cars on their sides, cranes, NTSB investigators in windbreakers, yellow tape.

Marc stands alone at the end of the platform in a hoodie, looking at it.

MARC (V.O.)
They say you never see the big ones coming.

A Port Washington train pulls into the station on its own tracks, slowly, its few late-night passengers looking out the windows toward the floodlights.

MARC (V.O.)
They're wrong. (beat) We see them coming every day. (beat) We just don't know what we're looking at until it's going through us.

Marc takes out his phone. Scrolls to RAVEN. Then HARMONY. His thumb hovers.

MARC (V.O.)
A woman waited four years to say three words.

He puts the phone away.

MARC (V.O.)
I'm not going to wait four years.

He turns and walks down the stairs toward Roosevelt Avenue and the 7 train home.

MARC (V.O.)
Soon.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x06

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NY1: BREAKING NEWS chyron

Thursday, October 20, 2005, 8:02 AM

"BREAKING: LIRR TRAINS COLLIDE EAST OF WOODSIDE; 'MANY INJURED'; MAIN LINE SERVICE SUSPENDED"

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS (front page): "HORROR ON THE MAIN LINE"

Friday, October 21, 2005

"Eleven people were killed and more than 140 injured yesterday when an eastbound Long Island Rail Road work train and a westbound Huntington commuter train collided just east of Woodside during the morning rush... Queens Grace Hospital in Long Island City, the nearest Level I trauma center, treated 104 victims. Among them were two strangers impaled on a single steel handrail; one survived... The NTSB has opened an investigation." *(Note: the collision is fictional, an in-world event of Mercy's Anatomy.)*

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "SADDAM HUSSEIN PLEADS INNOCENT AS TRIAL OPENS" / "WILMA BECOMES STRONGEST ATLANTIC HURRICANE ON RECORD"

October 19-20, 2005

"BAGHDAD (AP) -- A defiant Saddam Hussein pleaded innocent Wednesday as his trial opened..." / "MIAMI (AP) -- Hurricane Wilma's central pressure fell to 882 millibars, the lowest ever recorded in the Atlantic basin..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Thursday, October 20, 2005, 11:30 PM

"No jokes tonight. 104 patients through our doors. The pole couple: he lived, she didn't. Dr. X was with her for three hours and told her boyfriend himself. The Scary Intern, on MEDICAL LEAVE, tagged 104 people in the ambulance bay sitting on a wall, and wasn't wrong once. A 33-week baby named Hope was born in OR 6 while two surgeons operated on her mother's head and belly at the same time. And something happened on the twelfth floor at 6 PM, and Bernie's not talking, and Bernie always talks. Hug somebody." Comments (1,206).

Board of Trustees: sealed executive-session minutes (cover sheet only)

Thursday, October 20, 2005

"Executive session, 5:02-6:04 PM. Motion (Dr. H. Whitlow): review of Victor Donohue Foundation relationships with medical staff. Vote: 4 in favor, 4 opposed. MOTION FAILS. Disclosure by the Chief of Surgery received and SEALED. Nondisclosure agreements executed by all trustees present. -- F. Bassett, Counsel."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison to Harmony Divine)

Thursday, October 20, 2005, 3:41 PM

Raven: "i kissed her"

Raven: "in a supply room"

Harmony: "RAVEN"

Harmony: "i asked camille out. saturday. i went first"

Raven: "WHO ARE WE"

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x06

New Canon Established

- **The Woodside LIRR collision** (fictional in-world event): at 7:48 AM, October 20, 2005, an eastbound work train hit a westbound Huntington commuter train on the Main Line just east of Woodside. 11 dead, about 140 injured, and 104 treated at QGH. Natasha served as Incident Commander.
- **Lorraine Fuller** (41, a Bloomingdale's shoe and handbag buyer) and **Dwayne Ricks** (38, a Nassau court officer) were impaled on one vestibule handrail. The pole had transfixed her infrarenal aorta and was 'corking' it. Dwayne was freed first; Lorraine's calcified aorta split above the clamp, and Marc held it with his fingers. **Time of death 11:04 AM**, called by Marc. She told Keith Brantley 'I love you' for the first time at 10:26 AM ('Rainy'; he rode a bike over the Queensboro Bridge). Dwayne survived. This is the counterpart of Grey's Bonnie and Tom.
- **Marc said 'I've got it, Dad' on the table** in front of Robert, Elxa and Lowery. **Lowery has known since about August 3** ('Bullock's a common name. Not that common') and will keep it. Marc finally cried in the on-call room with his hand on Elxa's belly at 24 weeks (viability).
- **THE BOARD VOTE: 4 to 4, the motion fails.** In favor: Hollingsworth, Edmonds, Calloway and Judge Kittredge. Opposed: Truitt, Dr. Augusta Freeman, Simeon Howell and Rev. Ashworth. **Natasha disclosed in sealed executive session**, with Marc's consent ('Tell them... Don't let Whitlow say it first'), that Marc is her and Robert's son and Victor's grandson. She presented her January 9, 2005 recusal letter (Graves ranked the class), the NRMP match list and the Foundation comptroller's certification (no Foundation money to resident salaries since 1978). **The will and heir designation were NOT disclosed.** All trustees signed NDAs and the minutes are sealed. Whitlow heard the disclosure. Ashworth: 'That wasn't a confession. That was a testimony.'
- **Whitlow:** 'Secrets are like aortas. Once you open them, they don't close the way they used to.' Natasha told him about Joan's 1974 verdict to his face. Kennerly likely knows by tonight.
- **Marc has promised Raven and Harmony he'll tell them 'soon.'** 'Not not yet. Soon.' This sets up the 2x09 Thanksgiving reveal.
- **Amond (on leave) triaged 104 patients** in the ambulance bay, with none under-triaged and five re-triaged up. He sat when Arianna told him to and said 'Yes, sir' to Robert: 'I pressed the button.' Arianna re-checked his one black tag (a 19-year-old in a Hofstra sweatshirt).
- **Esther and Clayton**: a simultaneous cesarean and craniotomy on Tamar Wells in OR 6 (Graves allowed it: 'Policy 4.12 never met a train crash'). Baby Girl Wells, 'Hope,' was born at 33 weeks, 4 lb. Esther disclosed to Clayton that she wanted to comfort Marc; Clayton: 'I'm jealous... that's my problem, not yours.'
- **Raven and Arianna's first kiss**, in a Pit supply room ('I didn't see it raining'). **Harmony asked Camille out** for Saturday, October 22 ('I'm going first'). Harmony and Camille's first date was Friday, October 14 (they danced).
- Amond's return from leave remains about October 25. Arianna turns 26 on October 25.

Knowledge Tracker (as of October 20, 2005)

Who knows Marc is Natasha's son and Victor's grandson	How
Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, Esther	Earlier episodes
Dr. Lowery	Since about August 3; confirmed by 'Dad' on the table
All 8 trustees and Chairman Rawlings; Franklin Bassett	Natasha's sealed disclosure, October 20
Dr. Whitlow (and likely Kennerly)	In the room for the disclosure
Suspect: Raven, Harmony, Clayton, Monty	Raven and Harmony have been promised 'soon'
Heir designation	Still only Victor, Marc, V.J., the Foundation board (sealed letter) and Natasha

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Lorraine Fuller	6/12/1964 (41)	Transfixing pole injury through the infrarenal aorta	Ex-lap, aortic control, supraceliac clamp (Robert; Marc)	Died 11:04 AM
Dwayne Ricks	2/27/1967 (38)	Pole through the RLQ: bowel injury, flank	Ex-lap, bowel repair (Elxa; Lowery)	Survived
Tamar Wells	8/18/1974 (31)	Temporal epidural hematoma; placental abruption at 33 weeks	Simultaneous craniotomy (Graves; Esther) and cesarean (Clayton)	Both survived; Hope, 4 lb
Transit worker	-	Hemothorax (crush)	Chest tube (Marc; Gloria)	Stable
Mass casualty	-	104 patients; 31 fractures (Camille)	Triage (Amond)	11 dead on the line

New Characters

- **Lorraine Fuller** (1964-2005), **Keith Brantley** (b. September 9, 1962), **Dwayne Ricks** (b. February 27, 1967), **Monica Ricks** (b. May 5, 1969), **Tamar Wells** (b. August 18, 1974) and Hope Wells (b. October 20, 2005).
- **QGH Board of Trustees:** Chairman Theodore Rawlings (b. 1938), Judge Harold Kittredge (b. 1940), Dexter Hollingsworth (b. 1945), Cora Edmonds (b. 1947), James Calloway (b. 1961), Dr. Augusta Freeman (b. 1934), Simeon Howell (b. 1942), Mrs. Truitt and Rev. Ashworth.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- **The LIRR collision is fictional.** No such crash occurred on October 20, 2005. Real background: Saddam Hussein's trial opened October 19, 2005, and Hurricane Wilma reached 882 mb on October 19, a record Atlantic low. The Port Washington Branch stops at Woodside; the Main Line carries Huntington and Port Jefferson trains through Woodside.
- Medicine: a transfixing object is left in place until the OR, where proximal and distal vascular control comes before extraction. A calcified aorta may fracture at the clamp site, and supraceliac clamping is a salvage measure. Simultaneous cesarean delivery and craniotomy for a pregnant

trauma patient has been reported. Twenty-four weeks is the conventional threshold of viability. Resident salaries are funded mainly by Medicare GME.